

United Nations Human Rights Council
Study Guide



**Agenda: Human Rights Protection in
Conflict-Affected Regions of Sudan, with Particular
Emphasis on El Fasher and Greater Darfur**

Global School of Science Model United Nations

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Section I: Introduction

1.1 Letter from the Chair

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC). We convene at a historic and tragic juncture for the Republic of the Sudan, a nation currently engulfed in a civil war that is arguably the most violent and deadly of all contemporary conflicts. Since hostilities erupted on April 15, 2023, between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces (RSF), the country has been plunged into a cycle of destruction that has reversed decades of socioeconomic progress. At least 150,000 people have been killed, though the true death toll is likely much higher due to the compounding impacts of man-made starvation and the collapse of the national healthcare system.

Sudan currently represents the largest displacement crisis in the world, with approximately 14 million people—more than a quarter of the population—forced to flee their homes. This includes 9.5 million internally displaced persons (IDPs) and over 4.3 million who have sought refuge in neighboring states such as Egypt, Chad, and South Sudan. For those remaining, the situation is a "man-made catastrophe" where human rights are systematically disregarded and atrocities are committed with a blatant lack of regard for the rules of war.

The situation in Darfur, and specifically the fall of El Fasher in October 2025 after a siege lasting over 500 days, represents a tragic turning point in this conflict. The city, once a historical seat of power and a refuge for hundreds of thousands, has been transformed into what UN investigators now describe as a "crime scene". The fall of the city was accompanied by reported mass killings of civilians, ethnically targeted executions, and the destruction of the city's last remaining maternity hospital.

As members of this Council, your mandate is not merely to document these horrors but to identify actionable pathways for accountability, protection, and the restoration of human dignity. The international community's response has thus far been insufficient; bloodstains in El Fasher have been visible from space, yet the global "wake-up calls" have largely been ignored. I urge you to approach this session with the gravity it demands, moving beyond political pretense toward solutions that can finally silence the guns.

Sincerely,
Swechha Karn
President, UNHRC

Ehaan Neupane
Vice-President, UNHRC

1.2 Mandate of the UNHRC regarding the Sudan Crisis

The UNHRC's involvement in the Sudan crisis is anchored in its foundational responsibility to promote and protect all human rights and fundamental freedoms, guided by the UN Charter and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR). The Council operates under the principle that the Sudanese state bears the primary responsibility to protect its population from genocide, war crimes, and ethnic cleansing. When the state fails to do so, the Council must mobilize international pressure and oversight.

A central pillar of the Council's response is the Independent International Fact-Finding Mission (IFFM) for Sudan, established in October 2023. The IFFM is tasked with investigating alleged violations of international human rights and humanitarian law, with a specific request to conduct an urgent inquiry into the recent atrocities committed in and around El Fasher. The Council seeks to identify perpetrators to support future legal proceedings and ensure that justice prevails through robust criminal justice processes, including cooperation with the International Criminal Court (ICC).

The Council also demands that all parties allow and facilitate immediate, full, and unhindered humanitarian access to regions facing famine, specifically North Darfur and South Kordofan. Beyond documentation, the mandate involves advocating for a transition toward a democratically elected national government following a civilian-led dialogue. The Council remains "seized of the matter," meaning Sudan will remain a permanent priority on its agenda until the conflict is resolved and human rights are restored.

SUDAN WAR

Humanitarian situation in Sudan



51.7 million
total population



21.2m

are facing high
levels of **acute**
food insecurity



9.5m

people are
displaced internally



4.35m

people have
fled the country



10m

children
out of school



Women and girls
face heightened risks
and are exposed to
abuse and sexual
violence



Most conflict-affected
areas face large-scale
explosive hazard
contamination



Infographic: Humanitarian Situation in Sudan

Source: OCHA, Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC), and Al Jazeera.

1.3 Scope of the Agenda: Human Rights Protection in Conflict-Affected Regions

The scope of this committee's discussion is defined by the catastrophic human rights landscape in Sudan as of late 2025. While the conflict is nationwide, delegates must prioritize the implications of the RSF's assault on El Fasher and the wider Greater Darfur region. This

includes investigating the systematic transformation of civilian shelters and universities into "killing grounds" and the reporting of bodies piling in the streets and in mass trenches.

Beyond the immediate violence of the siege, the agenda encompasses the weaponization of hunger, as over 21.2 million people (45% of the population) face acute food insecurity. Famine has been officially confirmed in the Zamzam IDP camp and the town of Kadugli. The committee must address how belligerents have used starvation as a method of warfare by deliberately blocking food aid convoys and attacking humanitarian workers.

The systematic use of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) is a critical thematic priority. Reports indicate that rape and gang rape are being used as a deliberate strategy of domination and community humiliation, with women and girls being selected at gunpoint. These violations are frequently ethnically motivated, targeting communities such as the Masalit, Zaghawa, and Fur.

Delegates must also address the breakdown of public infrastructure, specifically the "total lack of regard" for protected objects under international law. This includes the occupation of schools for military use and the destruction of over 75% of hospitals in conflict zones, leaving millions without access to life-saving medical care. The targeting of the Saudi Maternity Hospital in El Fasher serves as a specific case study of this disregard for civilian safety.

Finally, the scope includes the regional stability risks posed by the spillover of millions of refugees into neighboring countries. The overcrowding of reception centers in countries like Uganda and Chad has created secondary humanitarian crises, including outbreaks of cholera and severe acute malnutrition among children. The committee is charged with finding solutions that not only address internal Sudanese human rights but also bolster the regional systems currently buckle under the strain of the crisis.

Section II: Historical Context and Background

2.1 Post-Colonial Turmoil and the First/Second Civil Wars

The contemporary human rights crisis in Sudan is rooted in centuries of regional tension and a colonial legacy that left a vast, diverse territory—once Africa's largest—struggling for internal unity. Following its joint administration as a colony of the United Kingdom and Egypt since 1899, Sudan officially gained independence in 1956. However, conflict predated official statehood, as the First Sudanese Civil War erupted in 1955 between the northern-based government and southern-based rebel groups such as the Anyanya and the Southern Sudan Liberation Movement (SSLM). These southern factions alleged that they were facing systematic ethnic and religious oppression for being non-Islamic and lacked any meaningful representation in the central government located in the capital, Khartoum. This

seventeen-year conflict, which resulted in over a million deaths, was temporarily resolved by the 1972 Addis Ababa Agreement, which established the Southern Sudan Autonomous Region.

Peace proved fragile, and the foundations of the second conflict were laid when President Gaafir Nimeiry began violating the autonomy of the southern region between 1979 and 1983 to seize control of oil fields along the internal border. In 1983, Nimeiry further exacerbated tensions by declaring all of Sudan an Islamic state, despite the southern region being majority non-Islamic. This triggered the Second Sudanese Civil War, led by the newly established Sudan People's Liberation Army (SPLA). Political instability in Khartoum intensified during this period, culminating in a military coup on June 30, 1989, led by General Omar al-Bashir. Bashir's thirty-year authoritarian rule was defined by the suppression of dissent, the oppression of non-Muslim civilians, and the commission of widespread human rights violations that resulted in approximately 2 million deaths. The war finally ended with the 2005 Comprehensive Peace Agreement (CPA), which eventually led to the secession of South Sudan in 2011.

2.2 The 2003 Darfur Conflict: Roots of the Janjaweed and Ethnic Tensions

In 2003, as the second civil war was nearing its conclusion, a separate and bloody conflict emerged in the Darfur region. Darfuri rebel groups, primarily the Justice and Equality Movement (JEM) and the Sudan Liberation Movement (SLM), launched an insurgency against the Khartoum government, accusing it of marginalizing and oppressing the region's non-Arab populations. In response, the al-Bashir regime deployed the "Janjaweed," a military-supported militia primarily composed of Arab tribes, to suppress the rebellion. The Janjaweed became infamous for systematic war crimes, including acts of ethnic cleansing and genocide against the Fur, Zaghawa, and Masalit communities.

The international response to the atrocities in Darfur led the United Nations Security Council to refer the situation to the International Criminal Court (ICC) in 2005. By 2013, the al-Bashir government formalized the remnants of the Janjaweed militia into the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), led by General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, better known as Hemedti. While the RSF was initially created to serve as a counter-insurgency force for the state, it quickly grew into a powerful, semi-independent paramilitary organization with its own financial networks, including control over Darfur's gold mining sector. During this era, General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, the current leader of the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF), also commanded regular army units in Darfur, establishing a history of cooperation between the two men who are now the primary belligerents of the current war.



Image: Rival Generals Hemedti and Al-Burhan

Source: BBC News and Copnall, 'Darfur conflict: Sudan's bloody stalemate.'

2.3 The Failed Transition to Democracy (2019-2021)

In April 2019, following months of mass civilian protests against rising food prices and authoritarian rule, General al-Burhan and General Hemedti collaborated to overthrow Omar al-Bashir in a military coup. This ousting raised global hopes for a democratic transition in Sudan. After intense negotiations with civilian protesters, a transitional government was established with a civilian Prime Minister, Abdalla Hamdok, and a Sovereign Council headed by al-Burhan and Hemedti. However, this "civilian-military" power-sharing arrangement was plagued by internal divisions and the military's reluctance to relinquish political and economic influence.

The fragile transition collapsed on October 25, 2021, when the SAF and RSF collaborated on a second coup to overthrow the civilian government and restore military rule. Although the two generals remained in power, their alliance rapidly deteriorated due to personal rivalries and disagreements over the future of the state's security architecture. The primary point of contention was the timeline for integrating the RSF into the national Sudanese Armed Forces; General al-Burhan demanded the unification of the forces within two years, while Hemedti sought a ten-year delay. This deadlock over military reform effectively stalled the resumption of talks for a new civilian-led constitution in early 2023.

2.4 Outbreak of Hostilities: The April 15, 2023, Turning Point

The simmering tensions between the SAF and RSF reached a breaking point on April 15, 2023, when heavy fighting erupted in Khartoum and quickly spread across the country. This eruption of violence transformed the power struggle between two generals into a nationwide civil war that has fragmented Sudan along shifting frontlines. The RSF achieved significant battlefield momentum during the first year of the war, capturing much of Khartoum and forcing the internationally recognized government to relocate its headquarters to Port Sudan on the Red Sea coast. In Darfur, the RSF and its allied militias resumed the targeted ethnic violence that had characterized the 2003 conflict, now on a larger and more brutal scale.

By late 2025, the war had resulted in a "total lack of regard" for human rights and the rules of war, with both parties accused of summary executions, the weaponization of hunger, and widespread sexual violence. The 500-day siege and subsequent fall of El Fasher in October 2025 marked the RSF's total control of the Darfur region, leaving civilians at the mercy of ethnically motivated killings. This ongoing catastrophe has created the world's largest displacement crisis, with 14 million people forced from their homes as the social fabric of the nation is systematically ripped apart.



Image: Sudan Territorial Control Map, July 2025

Source: Natasha Booty et al., 'Sudan War: A Simple Guide To What Is Happening,' BBC News.

Section II Endnote:

To understand the current war is to recognize that the same fuel which ignited Darfur in 2003—ethnic marginalization and military impunity—is now burning the entire nation. The "Janjaweed" did not disappear; they simply changed their name to the RSF and brought the atrocities of the desert to the gates of the capital.

Section III: Analysis of the Belligerents

3.1 The Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF): Leadership, Territory, and Strategies

The Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) represent the official military of the internationally recognized government of Sudan. Led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, who also serves as the Chairman of the Transitional Sovereignty Council, the SAF positions itself as the guardian of the Sudanese state and its territorial integrity. Following the outbreak of hostilities in April 2023 and the subsequent loss of much of the capital to paramilitary forces, the SAF-led government relocated its administrative headquarters to Port Sudan on the Red Sea coast. In early 2025, the SAF implemented constitutional amendments that officially postponed the transition to civilian rule until 2028 and significantly increased the military's formal power within the executive government.

Strategically, the SAF maintains primary control over Northern and Eastern Sudan, as well as the strategically vital Nile River corridor in the northernmost regions. Throughout 2025, the SAF achieved significant battlefield momentum, recapturing the central parts of Khartoum—including the Republican Palace—in March, and gaining full control of Khartoum state by mid-May. Despite these gains, the SAF has faced international criticism for its conduct during hostilities. UN investigators have documented the SAF's use of heavy artillery and aerial strikes, including the reported use of "barrel bombs" and drones, in densely populated civilian areas. Furthermore, the SAF has been accused of summary executions of individuals suspected of being RSF "collaborators" in areas they have recently recaptured, such as Wad Madani and neighborhoods in Khartoum.

3.2 The Rapid Support Forces (RSF): Origins, Financial Networks, and Territorial Gains

The Rapid Support Forces (RSF) is a powerful paramilitary organization led by General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, widely known as Hemedti. The RSF emerged from the remnants of the Janjaweed militias that gained notoriety for atrocities committed during the Darfur

conflict in the early 2000s. Formally established as a state-sanctioned force in 2013, the RSF eventually developed into a semi-autonomous military and economic entity with its own vast financial networks. Central to the RSF's power is its control over Sudan's gold mining sector, particularly in Darfur, which provides the organization with independent funding and leverage over international commodity markets.

By late 2025, the RSF held near-permanent control over the majority of the Darfur and Kordofan regions, as well as new territories along the borders of Libya and Egypt. The fall of El Fasher in October 2025, following a 500-day siege, represented a decisive victory for the RSF, effectively placing all of Darfur under its influence. In July 2025, a coalition of RSF-aligned groups announced the creation of a parallel government headquartered in Nyala, a move that was swiftly rejected by the African Union and the UN Security Council as an attempt to entrench the de facto partition of the country. The RSF has been implicated in systematic human rights violations, including the widespread use of sexual violence as a weapon of war and the forced recruitment of children, with reports of over 300 children undergoing military training at RSF camps near El Geneina.

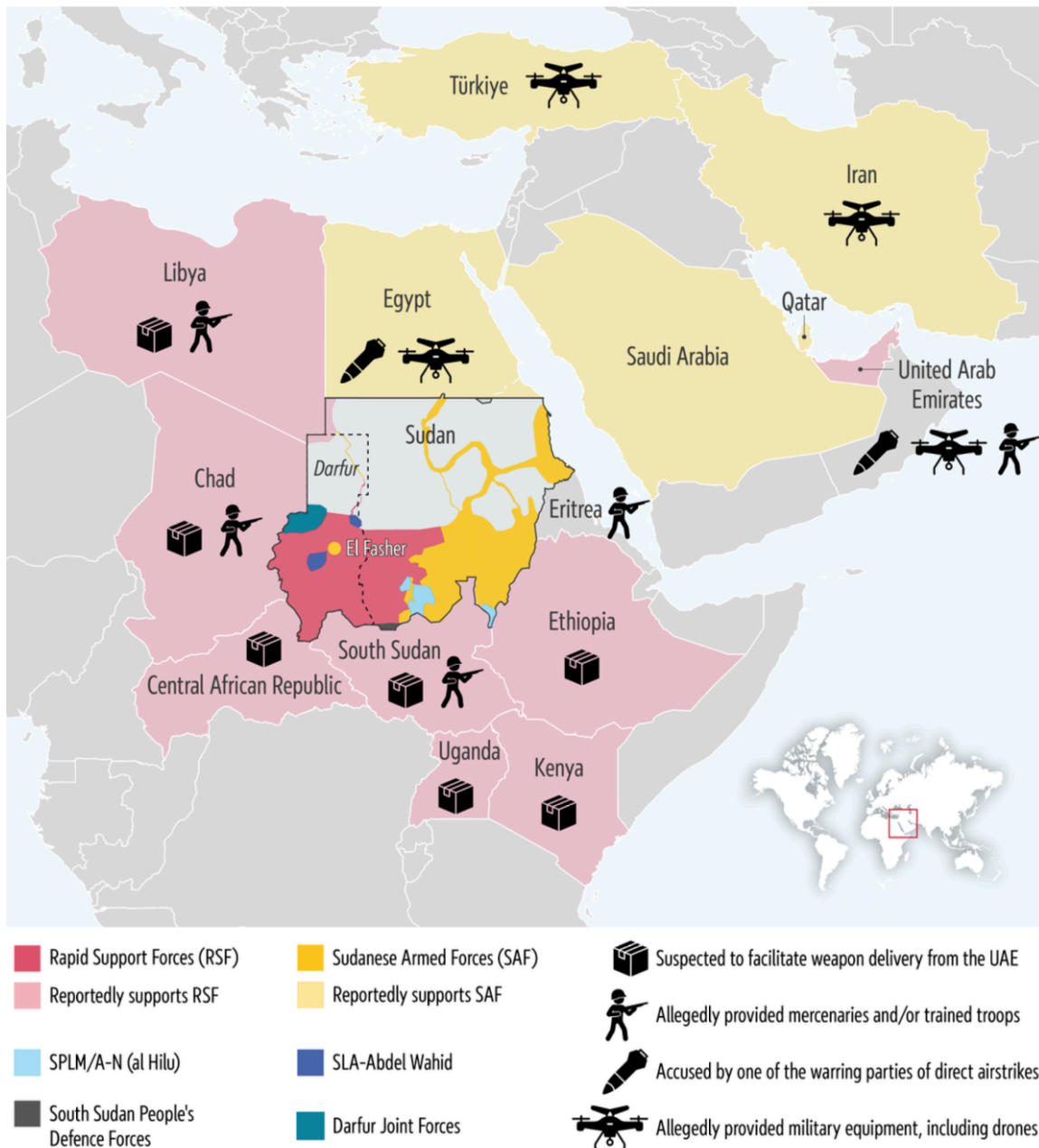


Image: Geopolitical Support Map

Source: EPRS, "Understanding the war in Sudan."

3.3 Aligned Militias and Armed Movements

The conflict between the SAF and RSF is further complicated by an intricate web of alignments involving various armed movements and tribal militias. Many of these groups were original signatories to the 2020 Juba Agreement for Peace but have since taken sides in the current civil war to protect their local interests or ethnic communities. Aligned with the SAF are several Darfuri factions, including the Justice and Equality Movement (JEM) and Minni Minawi's faction of the Sudan Liberation Army (SLA/MM), alongside the Al Bara'a

Brigade and the "mustanfreen"—civilians mobilized into "popular resistance" units to bolster regular army numbers.

Conversely, the RSF receives support from the Sudan Founding Alliance ("Tasis"), a coalition of political and armed groups that advocates for a federalist and secular state. Some factions, such as Abdul Wahid's SLA (SLA/AW), have allied with the RSF primarily to maintain their involvement in the lucrative gold trade. Other major actors have maintained more complex or neutral stances; for instance, the SPLM-N (Al-Hilu faction) primarily defends territories in the Blue Nile and South Kordofan against the SAF while occasionally cooperating with RSF-aligned coalitions in political forums. This proliferation of non-state actors has created a landscape where the rules of war are routinely ignored, as these smaller militias often operate outside of a centralized chain of command, leading to increased retaliatory violence and ethnic profiling across the country.

Section IV: Focal Point: The Crisis in El Fasher and Greater Darfur

4.1 The Strategic Significance of El Fasher

El Fasher, the capital of North Darfur, served for over two years as the final stronghold of the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) in a region otherwise dominated by paramilitary control. Its strategic value was not merely military but administrative and humanitarian; as the historical seat of the Darfur Sultanate, the city became a refuge for hundreds of thousands of internally displaced persons (IDPs) fleeing ethnic cleansing in West and South Darfur. For the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), capturing El Fasher was the final requirement to achieve near-total hegemony over the Darfur region, a move that international observers warned would entrench a de facto partition of the Sudanese state.

The city's fall in October 2025 followed a major RSF offensive that had intensified in April of that year, fundamentally shifting the battlefield momentum of the escalating war. By seizing this administrative hub, the RSF gained control over vital transit routes to the Libyan and Chadian borders, further enabling the illicit gold trade that fuels their financial network. For the international community, the city's collapse represented a failure to prevent a "foreseen and preventable" catastrophe, transforming a center of regional governance into what UN investigators now describe as a massive "crime scene".

4.2 The 500-Day Siege and the Fall of the City

The capture of El Fasher was the culmination of an 18-month campaign characterized by a "strangling" siege that deliberately targeted civilian survival. Beginning in May 2024, the

RSF and allied militias surrounded the city, cutting off supply routes for food, medicine, and water. Conditions within the city deteriorated to a point of profound desperation; by late 2025, civilians were reportedly reduced to eating animal feed and peanut shells to survive as famine conditions were officially confirmed in the region. The siege was punctuated by constant artillery shelling and drone strikes on civilian markets and residential areas, which served to demoralize the population and degrade public infrastructure.

In October 2025, the RSF launched its final assault, resulting in the reported killing of at least 1,500 civilians and the displacement of tens of thousands more. Survivors described a "bloodbath" as RSF fighters moved through the streets, conducting point-blank executions and systematic looting. Many of those attempting to flee were targeted on escape routes by criminal gangs and paramilitary checkpoints, where they faced invasive searches, forced nudity, and interrogation regarding their ethnic identity. The fall of the city marked the end of the SAF's military presence in Darfur and initiated a new chapter of unmitigated atrocities against the remaining population.

In September 2025, an estimated 21.2 million people, or 45 percent of the population, faced high levels of food insecurity. El-Fasher in North Darfur and the besieged town of Kadugli in South Kordofan have been classified as being in famine.

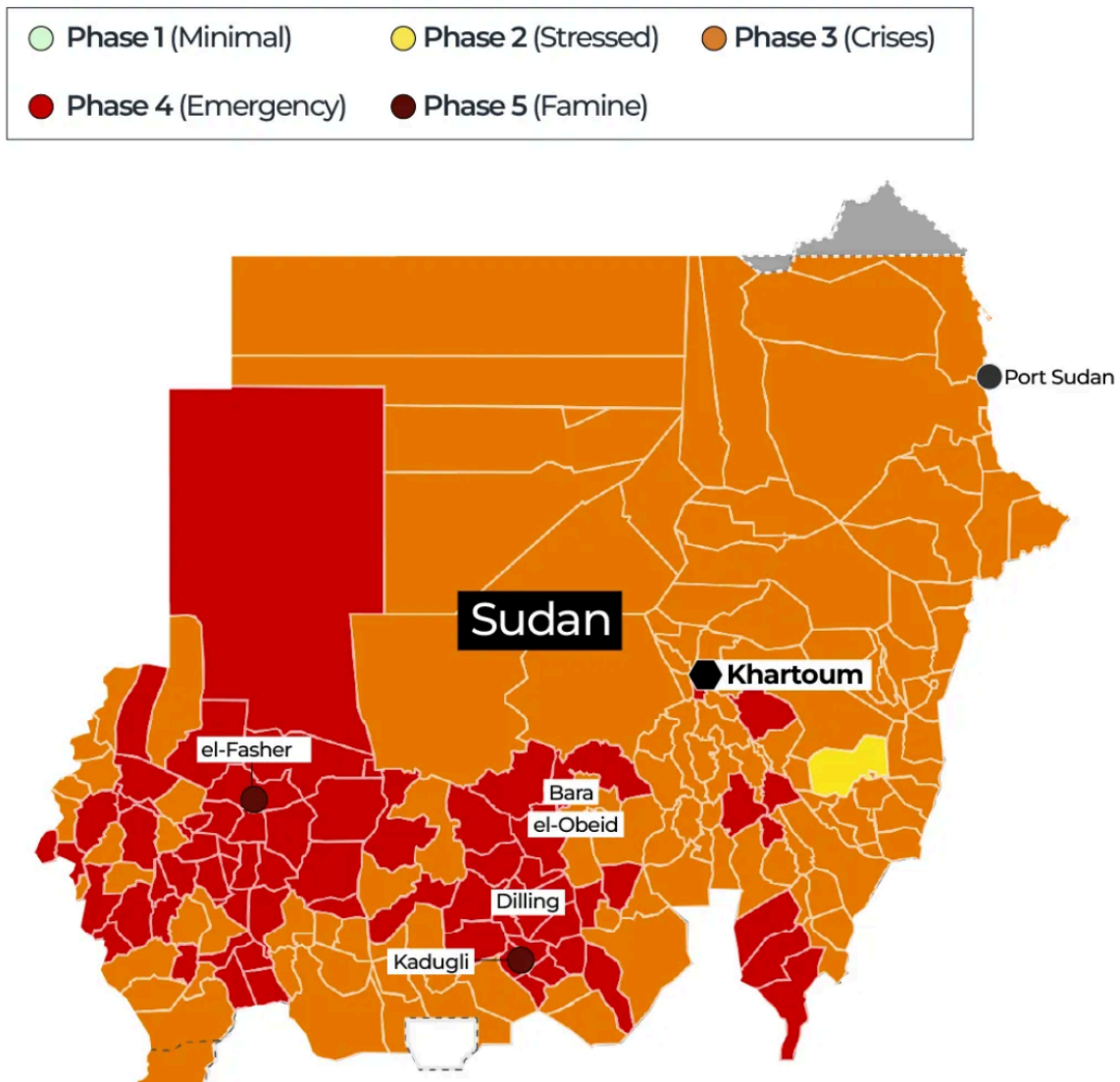


Image: Food Insecurity Map – Sudan, 2025

Source: Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) and Al Jazeera.

4.3 Case Study: Atrocities at the Saudi Hospital and Zamzam IDP Camp

The systematic disregard for protected objects under international humanitarian law is most visible in the attacks on the Saudi Maternity Hospital and the Zamzam IDP camp. The Saudi Hospital, the city's last remaining maternity and surgical facility, was repeatedly targeted by RSF artillery. Reports indicate that following the city's fall, RSF fighters entered the facility and summarily executed medical staff and patients, with one report documenting the killing of over 460 individuals within the hospital complex. This destruction effectively stripped

millions of Darfuris of access to life-saving reproductive and emergency care, leaving pregnant women and the wounded with no medical recourse.

Simultaneously, the Zamzam IDP camp, located south of El Fasher and hosting over 800,000 people, became a primary site of extermination. RSF fighters reportedly entered the camp's shelters near El Fasher University, selecting women and girls at gunpoint for gang rape as a deliberate strategy of community humiliation. Eyewitnesses documented bodies piling in trenches and streets, while survivors recounted children being hanged from trees as militia members celebrated. The systematic nature of these attacks, including the 11 summary executions of humanitarian staff working for health NGOs in April 2025, suggests a coordinated effort to eliminate the infrastructure of civilian support.

4.4 Ethnic Dimensions: Targeted Violence against the Masalit, Zaghawa, and Fur Communities

The violence in Greater Darfur has been characterized by a stark ethnic pattern that mirrors the 2003 genocide. RSF and allied Arab militias have systematically targeted non-Arab African communities, specifically the Fur, Zaghawa, and Masalit, whom they often disparagingly refer to as "falangai" (a derogatory term for enslaved persons). UN investigators have documented instances where victims were executed solely based on their perceived ethnic affiliation or suspected support for the SAF-aligned Joint Forces. This ethnically motivated violence includes the destruction of homes, farms, and water points to ensure the physical destruction of these groups.

The patterns of sexual violence are also deeply tied to ethnic identity; women from the Masalit and Zaghawa communities have been held in conditions of sexual slavery, with fighters specifically seeking out the wives of senior members of rival ethnic groups. This rising tide of hate speech and ethnically driven reprisals has led the AU Special Envoy on the Prevention of Genocide to warn that the "darkest chapters of this conflict" are currently unfolding. The systematic nature of these atrocities—broadcast across the internet by perpetrators who celebrate their crimes—constitutes a strong indicator of the deliberate intention to destroy these communities in whole or in part.

Section V: Thematic Human Rights Violations

5.1 Conflict-Related Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV)

The systematic use of sexual violence has emerged as one of the most defining and abhorrent features of the conflict in Sudan, particularly in the Darfur region. The United Nations and various human rights monitoring bodies have documented a pervasive pattern of sexual

violence, including rape, gang rape, and abductions for the purpose of sexual slavery. These acts are not merely incidental to the fighting but are employed as a deliberate strategy of domination, community humiliation, and ethnic subjugation. Between January and June 2025 alone, at least 164 incidents involving 228 victims were documented, though the actual magnitude is likely far greater due to the barriers of stigma, telecommunications blackouts, and fear of retaliation.

The vast majority of these violations—approximately 82 percent—are attributed to men in Rapid Support Forces (RSF) uniforms and their allied militias. Survivors from the Zamzam IDP camp and those fleeing El Fasher have recounted being selected at gunpoint and detained for days in conditions amounting to torture. The patterns of these crimes are starkly gendered and ethnicized; women from the Masalit, Zaghawa, and Fur communities are frequently targeted, with perpetrators sometimes explicitly inquiring about the wives of rival military leaders before committing assaults. This display of "naked cruelty" has left thousands without access to essential medical care, such as emergency contraception or post-exposure prophylaxis, further exacerbated by the deliberate destruction of reproductive health facilities.

5.2 Protection of Children: Forced Recruitment and Deprivation

The impact of the war on Sudan's youth has been catastrophic, characterized by a "total lack of regard" for the safety and rights of children. As of late 2025, an estimated 10 million children remain out of school due to the destruction or military occupation of classrooms, effectively halting the education of an entire generation. Beyond the loss of education, children face the constant threat of being killed or maimed by indiscriminate aerial strikes and drone attacks; in the first half of 2025, at least 191 children were confirmed killed during the conduct of hostilities.

One of the most pressing concerns for this Council is the widespread and forced recruitment of children into armed groups. The RSF has been specifically implicated in operating training camps, such as one near the El Geneina airport, where over 300 children—most under the age of 16—have been subjected to military training. This recruitment often follows a pattern of extreme pressure placed on community leaders to provide men and boys for the war effort under threat of punishment. Furthermore, children are increasingly vulnerable to sexual violence and summary executions; reports from survivors describe horrific scenes in which children were reportedly hanged from trees by militia members during celebrations following the fall of cities.

5.3 Weaponization of Hunger and Famine Conditions

For the first time in nearly two decades, famine conditions have been officially confirmed in parts of Sudan, specifically within the Zamzam IDP camp and the town of Kadugli. The "man-made catastrophe" of food insecurity is a direct result of the deliberate starvation of civilians as a method of warfare, which is expressly forbidden under international

humanitarian law. Over 21.2 million people—roughly 45 percent of the population—now face acute food insecurity, with hundreds of thousands in "Phase 5" or famine levels of hunger.

Belligerents on both sides have contributed to this crisis by blocking humanitarian access and attacking food aid convoys. On June 2, 2025, a United Nations humanitarian convoy carrying life-saving supplies from the WFP and UNICEF was struck by drones in North Darfur, resulting in five deaths and the destruction of vital food stocks. In besieged areas like El Fasher, the RSF has restricted the movement of goods and imposed exorbitant fees on those attempting to flee, forcing residents to survive on peanut shells and animal feed. This weaponization of hunger serves to demoralize the population and eliminate the infrastructure of civilian support.

5.4 Summary Executions and Arbitrary Detention

The shift in territorial control between the SAF and RSF has consistently been accompanied by waves of retaliatory violence and summary executions. Between January and June 2025, at least 990 civilians were unlawfully killed outside the immediate context of fighting, many of whom were accused of being "collaborators" with the opposing side. Following the SAF's recapture of Khartoum state in mid-2025, a surge in executions was documented where youths as young as 14 were arrested and killed on the spot based on suspected RSF affiliation. Perpetrators often use dehumanizing language, referring to victims as "pests" or "animals" to justify their extermination.

Arbitrary detention remains widespread, with both formal and informal facilities used to hold civilians incommunicado under harsh conditions. In RSF-controlled areas, abandoned schools and government buildings are frequently used as makeshift prisons where detainees face severe beatings, electric shocks, and a total denial of medical care. The discovery of mass graves in Omdurman and Khartoum North, containing hundreds of bodies, points to a pattern of enforced disappearances and deaths in custody resulting from torture and starvation. These "collaborator" purges have created a climate of fear that suppresses civic space and discourages the reporting of human rights abuses.

5.5 Attacks on Medical Facilities and Protected Infrastructure

The collapse of Sudan's healthcare system is perhaps the most visible indicator of the "total lack of regard" for the rules of war. Fewer than 25 percent of hospitals in conflict zones remain operational, leaving millions without access to treatment for cholera and other rising disease outbreaks. Medical facilities are routinely occupied for military use or targeted by artillery and drones. A horrific case study is the Saudi Maternity Hospital in El Fasher, which was the only remaining surgical facility in the city; it was repeatedly shelled before RSF fighters allegedly entered the complex and executed over 460 patients and staff.

Humanitarian staff have also been targeted with lethal frequency, with at least 30 health and aid workers killed in the first half of 2025 alone. This includes the summary execution of NGO staff members who were found hiding in bomb shelters during the RSF assault on the Zamzam camp. Beyond hospitals, critical infrastructure such as electricity grids and water collection points have been deliberately attacked, forcing civilians to consume unsafe water and leading to over 123,000 confirmed cholera cases. These attacks on protected objects serve no military purpose other than to make the environment uninhabitable for civilian populations.

Section VI: The Humanitarian Landscape

6.1 Internal and External Displacement: The World's Largest Homeless Crisis

Sudan currently faces the world's largest humanitarian and displacement crisis, a catastrophe that has seen more than 14 million people—over a quarter of the country's total population—flee their homes since April 2023. Of this number, approximately 9.5 million to 11.5 million people are internally displaced persons (IDPs) scattered across nearly 11,000 locations in all 18 states of the country. The demographics of this crisis are particularly alarming, as children represent 51 percent of the total displaced population. While major displacement originated from Khartoum state (2.7 million) and South Darfur (2 million), the most recent surge has been driven by the fall of El Fasher, with tens of thousands arriving in nearby towns like Tawila in an acutely malnourished state.

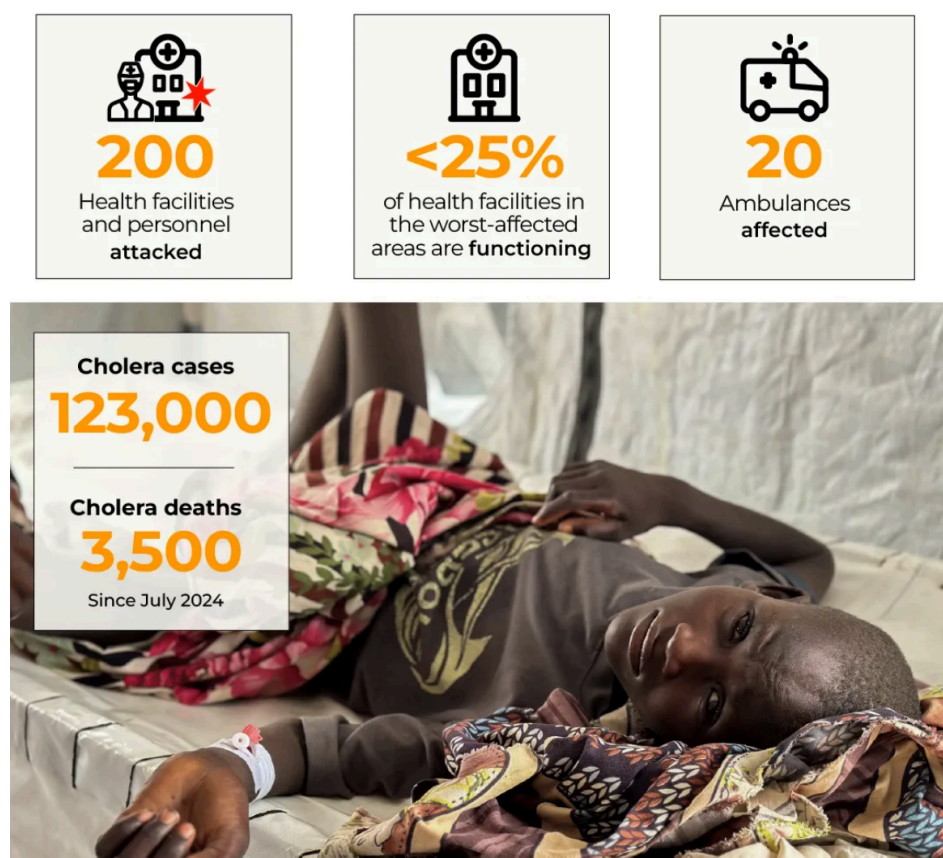
The external movement of refugees has placed an unprecedented strain on the Horn of Africa and the Middle East. Over 4.35 million people have sought refuge in neighboring countries, with Egypt (1.5 million), South Sudan (1.25 million), and Chad (1.2 million) acting as the primary recipients. This mass exodus includes not only Sudanese nationals but also nearly 30 percent who are non-Sudanese, many of whom were refugees already living in Sudan before the conflict began. While some "return movements" were documented in mid-2025 to areas like Khartoum and Al Jazirah following the Sudanese Armed Forces' (SAF) territorial gains, these movements are often driven by desperation rather than the restoration of safety.

6.2 Public Infrastructure Collapse: Water, Electricity, and Healthcare

The war has effectively shattered Sudan's public infrastructure, reducing once-thriving urban centers to "burnt-out shells". The healthcare system is on the brink of total collapse; currently, fewer than 25 percent of hospitals in conflict-affected areas remain operational. The World Health Organization has documented over 200 targeted attacks on health facilities and personnel, including the destruction of ambulances and the occupation of hospitals for

military use. This collapse has left 30 million people—64 percent of the population—in urgent need of humanitarian assistance.

Access to basic utilities has been systematically degraded by the use of drone technology targeting civilian infrastructure. In May 2025, a series of drone strikes in Port Sudan targeted electricity substations and fuel storage facilities, leading to widespread power cuts that halted the operation of water desalination plants. Consequently, over 18.9 million people across Sudan lack access to safe drinking water and sanitation services. This water scarcity has directly fueled a massive cholera outbreak, resulting in over 123,000 confirmed cases and at least 3,500 deaths since July 2024. Furthermore, the education of an entire generation has been suspended, with 10 million children out of school due to classrooms being destroyed, occupied by military forces, or used as IDP shelters.



Infographic: Sudan Health Infrastructure

Source: World Health Organization and OCHA via Al Jazeera.

6.3 Regional Spillover: Challenges in Chad, Egypt, Ethiopia, and South Sudan

The humanitarian crisis has overwhelmed the response capacities of neighboring states, many of which are themselves grappling with internal instability. Egypt has become the top receiving country for those fleeing the conflict, with its registered refugee population

surpassing one million in June 2025. Despite this role as a stabilizer, the influx has forced Egypt to launch a \$339 million "Refugee and Resilience Response Plan" to manage the strain on its host communities. In Chad, the situation is even more precarious; screenings in the Wadi Fira province revealed a global acute malnutrition (GAM) rate of 30 percent among newly arrived children, a figure that is double the emergency threshold.

In South Sudan, the spillover has manifested as a "returnee" crisis, with over 1.1 million arrivals primarily consisting of South Sudanese nationals who had been living in Sudan. Relocation efforts from border transit centers like Renk and Malakal have been suspended due to severe funding shortages and the deterioration of road conditions during the rainy season, increasing the risk of communicable diseases like Hepatitis E. Meanwhile, Uganda has registered over 85,000 Sudanese refugees, but its reception centers are operating at extreme overcapacity—Kiryandongo is currently at 360 percent of its intended occupancy. These regional strains represent a "humanitarian contagion" that threatens to destabilize the entire Horn of Africa if international funding—which currently covers only 16 to 29 percent of required levels—is not dramatically increased.

Section VII: Geopolitics and Foreign Involvement

7.1 Regional Interests: Egypt, the UAE, Saudi Arabia, and the "Quad"

The conflict in Sudan is no longer a localized struggle for power but has transformed into a catastrophic proxy battle for natural resources and regional influence. Strategically positioned between Sub-Saharan Africa and the Arab world, Sudan's location along the Red Sea strategic waterways and its vast gold reserves have drawn in neighboring powers with competing geostrategy. Egypt has emerged as a primary supporter of the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the internationally recognized government, viewing them as essential partners for regional stability and as a counterweight to Ethiopian influence concerning the Grand Ethiopian Renaissance Dam on the River Nile. This support has manifested through military provisions, diplomatic backing, and alleged airstrikes against Rapid Support Forces (RSF) positions. For Cairo, the survival of the SAF is inextricably linked to Egypt's own national security and water rights.

Conversely, the United Arab Emirates (UAE) is widely considered by international observers to be the primary provider of arms, mercenaries, and financial support to the RSF. Although the UAE has officially denied these claims, reports indicate that their involvement is driven by a desire to secure permanent access to Sudan's gold mines and agricultural resources. Evidence suggests a secret financial network where Darfuri gold is smuggled into the UAE in exchange for military equipment, including drones that have been used to strike Port Sudan. This involvement has led the SAF-led government to formally accuse the UAE of complicity

in genocide, though jurisdictional hurdles at the International Court of Justice have stalled legal proceedings.

Saudi Arabia has sought to play a more balanced role, leaning toward the SAF while leading critical mediation efforts such as the "Jeddah process". Driven partly by regional competition with the UAE, the Saudi government has expressed interest in funding the eventual reconstruction of Khartoum. These regional interests converged on September 12, 2025, when a coalition known as the "Quad"—comprising Egypt, Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and the United States—issued a roadmap for a three-month humanitarian truce. While this roadmap represented a diplomatic breakthrough, its implementation has been hampered by SAF's rejection of the UAE's role, which they denounce as an attempt to dismantle the national military in favor of the RSF.

7.2 International Powers: Role of the UNSC, Russia, China, and the US

The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) has struggled to maintain a unified front due to the conflicting interests of its permanent veto-holding members. While the Council is compelled by the UN Charter to act, China and Russia have consistently favored a more cautious approach that emphasizes state sovereignty. Russia has maintained a complex and often contradictory stance; it officially supports the SAF regime, having secured an agreement to establish a military base in Port Sudan, yet Russian-sponsored paramilitary groups are reported to control gold mines within RSF-controlled territories. This dual engagement has led to the unusual presence of Ukrainian special forces fighting alongside the SAF to disrupt the flow of Sudanese gold intended to fund Russia's war efforts elsewhere.

China remains one of Sudan's most influential trade partners, viewing the country as a vital source of oil, raw materials, and agricultural products. Unlike Russia, China has supported UN arms embargoes to prevent further circulation of weapons, though it remains hesitant to support any intervention that it perceives as violating Sudanese sovereignty. Beijing's primary goal is the security of South Sudanese oil transiting through Port Sudan, leading it to maintain a pragmatic diplomatic presence with the SAF government. Meanwhile, other international actors like Türkiye and Iran have significantly bolstered the SAF's capabilities by supplying advanced drone technology, which has been instrumental in the military's 2025 offensives in Khartoum.

The United States' approach has undergone a shift in late 2025. Under the Biden administration, policy was primarily humanitarian and based on enforcing international law, including the conclusion that RSF members committed genocide in Darfur. However, the current administration has signaled a pivot toward a less punitive strategy, focusing instead on potential investment opportunities with the eventual winner of the conflict and urging higher-level diplomatic engagements facilitated by Saudi Arabia. Despite this high-level attention, Washington's influence remains limited by its strategic relationships with the external actors—such as the UAE and Egypt—who continue to fuel the fires of war.

7.3 Sanctions and Arms Embargoes: Effectiveness and Violations

International efforts to curtail the violence through economic pressure have resulted in a complex web of sanctions. UNSC Resolution 2791 (2025) extended travel bans, asset freezes, and the long-standing arms embargo on Darfur until September 2026. However, this resolution notably lacks a clear reference to the surge in sexual violence or the use of foreign mercenaries, largely due to opposition from Russia. The effectiveness of the Darfur embargo is further undermined by the fact that it does not cover the entire country, allowing weapons to be legally imported into Port Sudan before being smuggled into conflict zones.

The European Union (EU) has implemented its own targeted sanctions, prohibiting the provision of military services to all parties and freezing the assets of entities connected to the RSF's mining and trading networks. On November 20, 2025, the EU imposed specific sanctions on Abdelrahim Dagalo, the RSF's second-in-command, for his role in atrocities committed during the fall of El Fasher. Similarly, the US has sanctioned SAF-aligned entities following investigations into the military's alleged use of chemical weapons, specifically chlorine gas, in mid-2025.

Despite these measures, the country remains "awash with smuggled weapons," including those manufactured in European factories. The UN Fact-Finding Mission has called for a stricter and more comprehensive national embargo, noting that those who back and arm this "machinery of brutality" have both the power and the legal duty to halt it. As long as external actors continue to prioritize resource extraction and geostrategic leverage over human rights, the international sanctions regime will remain an incomplete tool for de-escalation.

Section VIII: Legal Frameworks and International Action

8.1 The Independent International Fact-Finding Mission (FFM) for Sudan

The primary mechanism for human rights accountability within the United Nations system is the Independent International Fact-Finding Mission (FFM) for Sudan, which was established by the Human Rights Council in October 2023. The Council has since extended the Mission's mandate until October 2026, reflecting the international community's recognition of the protracted nature of the conflict and the necessity for continuous monitoring. A central component of the FFM's current work is an urgent inquiry into the violations of international law committed during and around the fall of El Fasher. This specific mandate requires the Mission to identify perpetrators and document large-scale atrocities, including ethnically motivated killings, summary executions, and the systematic use of sexual and gender-based violence as a weapon of war.

The FFM operates under the legal standard of "reasonable grounds to believe" to establish facts and support future criminal justice processes. Despite facing significant challenges, including a liquidity crisis at the United Nations and persistent telecommunications blackouts that hinder accurate reporting, the FFM continues to interview witnesses and collect verified digital evidence. The Council has emphasized that the Mission's work must be complementary to regional investigations and national accountability efforts, although the collapse of Sudan's domestic judicial system has placed the burden of proof primarily on international bodies. The findings of these investigations are scheduled for presentation at the Council's sixty-first session to facilitate an enhanced interactive dialogue on the path toward justice.

8.2 The International Criminal Court (ICC) and Judicial Accountability

The International Criminal Court (ICC) remains the leading international judicial body investigating alleged war crimes and crimes against humanity in the Darfur region. Since July 2023, the Office of the Prosecutor has been actively investigating the current hostilities, finding "reasonable grounds" to believe that atrocities mirroring the 2003 conflict are being repeated. Current investigations are particularly focused on the siege of El Fasher and the targeted violence against non-Arab communities such as the Masalit, Zaghawa, and Fur. However, the ICC faces severe obstacles, including resource constraints and limited access to key information sources within Darfur, which complicate the collection of forensic evidence.

The crisis is further complicated by the status of individuals previously indicted by the ICC for genocide, including former President Omar al-Bashir and former Minister Ahmad Muhammad Harun. These individuals escaped from Kober Prison in Khartoum at the start of the current war and remain at large, effectively evading prosecution for decades-old crimes. While some Member States strongly support the ICC's work, others, including Russia and China, have vocalized opposition, arguing for the primacy of Sudan's existing judicial institutions or accusing the Court of political bias. This lack of unity within the Security Council prevents the Court from receiving the adequate political backing and resources required to enforce outstanding arrest warrants.

8.3 Regional Legal Frameworks: The African Union and Article 4(h)

The African Union (AU) plays a pivotal role in the legal architecture of the conflict, guided by its Constitutive Act and the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights. A critical point of legal discourse involves Article 4(h) of the AU Constitutive Act, which grants the Union the unique power to intervene in a Member State under grave circumstances, such as war crimes, genocide, and crimes against humanity. Following the atrocities in El Fasher, the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights (ACHPR) released a Fact-Finding Report recommending the deployment of an AU peacekeeping mission to Sudan consistent with this article. However, the AU Peace and Security Council (PSC) has thus far refrained

from invoking this power, largely confining its response to monitoring and diplomatic condemnation.

The PSC has tasked the AU Commission with developing a comprehensive plan for the protection of civilians and has established a standing mechanism for the continuous documentation of violations. This mechanism consists of a joint team from the ACHPR and the AU Special Envoy on the Prevention of Genocide. Despite these institutional steps, regional efforts are often hampered by a lack of progress in identifying the external actors supporting the warring parties. To address this, there have been proposals to appoint a high-profile former head of state to oversee the documentation of foreign military support, aiming to create a legal basis for regional sanctions against those fueling the conflict.

8.4 Mediation Frameworks: Jeddah, IGAD, and the Quad Roadmap

Beyond formal judicial proceedings, international action is structured around several competing and complementary mediation frameworks. The Jeddah Declaration of Commitment to Protect the Civilians of Sudan, signed on May 11, 2023, remains the foundational legal document for civilian protection, obligating both the SAF and RSF to allow humanitarian relief and refrain from using civilians as human shields. While these commitments have been routinely violated, they serve as the legal benchmark against which the conduct of both parties is measured by the UN and AU. Furthermore, the Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD) has drafted roadmaps for a political settlement, though these efforts have faced rejection from the SAF leadership.

The most recent significant diplomatic effort is the US-led "Quad" initiative, involving Egypt, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE, which issued a joint statement on September 12, 2025. This roadmap calls for a three-month humanitarian truce to facilitate the entry of aid, followed by a transition to an inclusive, civilian-led government within nine months. While the RSF has tactically welcomed the initiative to rehabilitate its international image, the SAF has rejected the UAE's participation, denouncing it as a threat to Sudanese sovereignty. The success of these roadmaps ultimately depends on the international community's ability to transition from "pretense and performance" to coordinated, sustained pressure on both the belligerents and their external backers.

Section IX: Latest Developments and Current Challenges to Peace

9.1 The Shifting Frontlines: Escalation in Kordofan and the Red Sea

As of late 2025, the conflict in Sudan has entered a phase of aggressive expansion, with the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) seeking to consolidate their battlefield momentum following the fall of El Fasher. The RSF has turned its sights toward the Kordofan region, advancing into major urban centers such as El Obeid and capturing the 22nd Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) division headquarters in Babanusa. A particularly significant development occurred in South Kordofan, where the RSF seized the strategic Heglig oilfield, forcing the withdrawal of southern-aligned forces and threatening a vital component of Sudan's remaining economic infrastructure. This escalation has brought a new wave of documented atrocities; UN High Commissioner for Human Rights Volker Türk reported at least 269 civilian deaths in North Kordofan since October 2025, characterized by summary executions, abductions, and retaliatory killings following the capture of Bara city.

The conflict has also begun to touch regions previously spared from direct ground combat. In May 2025, Port Sudan—the current seat of the internationally recognized government—faced an unprecedented series of long-range drone strikes attributed to the RSF. These attacks targeted critical civilian infrastructure, including the main electricity substation and fuel storage facilities, resulting in widespread power outages that paralyzed water desalination plants and hospitals. This expansion of drone warfare underscores a "total lack of regard" for protected civilian objects and signals that the RSF is capable of striking the SAF's administrative heart, further complicating prospects for a localized ceasefire.

9.2 Stalled Peace Initiatives: The Quad Roadmap and Diplomatic Deadlocks

International mediation efforts reached a critical juncture on September 12, 2025, when the "Quad" coalition—comprising Egypt, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, and the United States—issued a joint roadmap for peace. The proposal called for an immediate three-month humanitarian truce to facilitate aid entry, followed by a transition to an inclusive, civilian-led government within nine months. While the African Union and IGAD welcomed the initiative as being aligned with their own roadmaps, its implementation has been crippled by deep-seated mistrust between the belligerents. The SAF leadership formally rejected the plan, denouncing the UAE's participation as a biased attempt to dismantle the national military in favor of a paramilitary rival.

Conversely, the RSF's reaction has been described as a "tactical move" to rehabilitate its international image. Although the RSF expressed readiness for talks, they have been accused of repeatedly violating the terms of the humanitarian truce and continuing their territorial expansion. This stalemate is exacerbated by a perceived lack of sustained engagement from the United States, whose influence is limited by its strategic relationships with the very external actors—such as the UAE and Egypt—that continue to fund and arm the warring factions. Without a coordinated mechanism to exert pressure on these foreign backers, the Quad Roadmap risks becoming another "paper promise" in a long history of failed Sudanese peace processes.

9.3 Attacks on International Personnel and Humanitarian Facilities

The safety of international actors in Sudan has deteriorated sharply, reaching a tragic low on December 13, 2025, when drone attacks targeted the logistics base of the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei (UNISFA) in Kadugli. The strike killed six peacekeepers and injured eight others, prompting UN Secretary-General António Guterres to warn that such actions may constitute war crimes. This incident highlights the increasing danger to those attempting to maintain the thin line of humanitarian stability in Kordofan, where famine has already been confirmed in Kadugli.

Humanitarian operations continue to be weaponized by both sides to gain leverage. In June 2025, a UN convoy carrying life-saving nutrition supplies from the WFP and UNICEF was struck by drones in North Darfur, resulting in five deaths and the destruction of vital food stocks intended for the starving population of El Fasher. These systematic attacks on aid workers—over 30 of whom were killed in the first half of 2025 alone—have forced many NGOs to suspend operations, leaving millions without a safety net. The Council must address this "machinery of brutality" that treats the delivery of bread and medicine as a military target.

9.4 Accountability and Sanctions: Recent Penalties

In response to the escalating violence, international bodies have moved toward more punitive measures, though their impact on the ground remains debatable. On November 20, 2025, the European Union imposed targeted sanctions on Abdelrahim Dagalo, the RSF's second-in-command, for his role in the atrocities committed during the siege of El Fasher. This followed a U.S. determination that the SAF had utilized chemical weapons, specifically chlorine gas, in conflict zones, leading to new restrictions on American exports to Sudan.

Despite these individual penalties, the UN Security Council remains divided on broader action. While the Darfur arms embargo was extended until September 2026 via Resolution 2791, it continues to exclude a national mandate, allowing weapons to flow into the country legally through Port Sudan before being diverted to frontlines. Furthermore, Russia and China have consistently opposed resolutions they perceive as undermining Sudanese sovereignty or threatening their own resource interests, such as the control of gold mines. As long as the international community remains split between those seeking accountability and those protecting their geostrategic stakes, the cycle of impunity is likely to continue.

Section X: Frameworks for Collaborative Action and Human Rights Resolution

The United Nations Human Rights Council plays a distinct but central role in responding to the crisis in Sudan. Unlike the Security Council, it does not authorize military operations or impose sanctions. Its authority lies in investigation, monitoring, and accountability. In a conflict where violations are systematic, repeated, and often denied, the Council's work is essential for transforming atrocity into legally and politically actionable evidence.

For delegates, the key task is ensuring that documentation and reporting do not stop at statements but feed into mechanisms that can hold perpetrators accountable, protect civilians, and guide regional and international action. In areas such as El Fasher and Greater Darfur, the credibility, consistency, and continuity of human rights monitoring will determine whether violations are treated as isolated incidents or as part of an identifiable pattern of international crimes.

10.1 Responding to Mass Atrocities and Famine Conditions

The conflict in Sudan has entered its third year, with widespread civilian targeting and the collapse of basic survival systems. In Darfur and parts of Kordofan, the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) have advanced following the fall of El Fasher, and siege tactics have restricted access to food, water, and medical aid, creating famine conditions confirmed in the Zamzam IDP camp and Kadugli. Civilians in besieged areas have reportedly been forced to survive on animal feed.

Both the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the RSF have shown persistent disregard for the rules of war. Documented violations include the targeted bombing of hospitals, attacks on civilian infrastructure, and the systematic use of sexual violence against women and girls from non-Arab communities.

The Council's responsibility is to document these acts and assess them as violations of international humanitarian and human rights law. Delegates should focus on monitoring compliance with the Jeddah Declaration, particularly the obligation to allow immediate and unhindered humanitarian access. While the Council cannot establish humanitarian corridors, it can identify patterns of obstruction and transmit findings to relevant enforcement bodies.

10.2 Overcoming Barriers to Monitoring and Documentation

Persistent telecommunications blackouts, internet shutdowns, and surveillance of public communication spaces have made real-time reporting of retaliatory violence, summary executions, and displacement extremely difficult. In many areas, intelligence personnel monitor public internet access points, creating severe risks for civilians and journalists attempting to share information. These restrictions significantly constrain the Independent International Fact-Finding Mission (IFFM), the Council's primary investigative mechanism. Despite the extension of its mandate to October 2026, the IFFM faces operational challenges due to ongoing UN liquidity crises.

Delegates should consider mechanisms to ensure continuity in monitoring, including closer cooperation with regional bodies such as the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights and the AU Special Envoy. A standing or semi-permanent monitoring arrangement would reduce reliance on short-term mandates and help ensure consistent evidence collection, even under access restrictions.

10.3 Addressing Impunity and Supporting Accountability

The atrocities unfolding in Darfur reflect decades of impunity following the 2003 conflict. Weak domestic prosecutions, selective judicial processes, and insufficient international follow-up allowed patterns of violence to persist. In the current conflict, Sudanese courts have handed down over 100 death sentences based on geographic and ethnic profiling. At the start of the war, several high-profile ICC-indicted individuals escaped from prison, signaling the collapse of domestic judicial accountability. The ICC has also found reasonable grounds to believe war crimes are recurring.

Although the Human Rights Council cannot prosecute individuals, its work is critical for enabling future accountability. Delegates should ensure that FFM findings are detailed and legally rigorous, linking patterns of abuse to command structures, documenting ethnic targeting, sexual violence, and the involvement of external actors. By maintaining sustained focus on accountability, the Council helps prevent political negotiations from sidelining justice in favor of short-term stability.

10.4 Protecting Civic Space and Supporting Political Transition

Civic space in Sudan has been severely restricted. At least 15 journalists have been killed, and approximately 90 percent of media outlets have shut down, leaving civilians increasingly dependent on propaganda and rumor. Both SAF and RSF forces have targeted civil society actors under accusations of "collaboration," undermining independent reporting and humanitarian work.

Emergency Response Rooms (ERRs) and local humanitarian volunteers remain critical lifelines for civilians, yet they operate under constant threat. The Human Rights Council has a mandate to document reprisals against journalists, civil society actors, and humanitarian volunteers, and to call for their protection as a core human rights obligation.

Politically, the Council should reject the establishment of parallel governing authorities, including those announced by RSF-aligned coalitions, which risk permanent fragmentation. Delegates should emphasize that any transition must be civilian-led, inclusive, and involve women and youth. These are not optional policy preferences, but requirements under international human rights law for legitimacy and protection of fundamental freedoms.

Section XI: Committee Resources

11.1 Key Terms and Definitions

To engage effectively in the United Nations Human Rights Council (UNHRC), delegates must be well-versed in the terminology that defines the legal and humanitarian landscape of the Sudan crisis. The Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) refers to the official national military of Sudan, currently led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan and headquartered in Port Sudan. Its primary adversary, the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), is a powerful paramilitary organization led by General Mohamed Hamdan 'Hemedti' Dagalo; it evolved from the Janjaweed militias that were notorious for committing atrocities during the 2003 Darfur conflict. The term Janjaweed specifically refers to military-supported Arab militias used by the former al-Bashir regime to suppress non-Arab African communities.

The humanitarian crisis is often described using classifications from the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC). IPC Phase 5 (Famine) is the most severe level of hunger, characterized by widespread starvation and death, which has been officially confirmed in the Zamzam IDP camp and the town of Kadugli as of late 2025. Another critical term is Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs), referring to the 9.5 to 11.5 million individuals forced to flee their homes but who remain within Sudan's borders.

Delegates must also understand the legal mechanisms at play. Article 4(h) of the African Union (AU) Constitutive Act is a unique provision that grants the AU the power to intervene in a Member State in grave circumstances, such as genocide or war crimes. The "Quad" is a diplomatic coalition consisting of Egypt, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, and the United States, which issued a major roadmap for a humanitarian truce in September 2025. Finally, the Jeddah Declaration, signed in May 2023, serves as the foundational commitment by both the SAF and RSF to protect civilians and allow the passage of humanitarian aid.

11.2 Questions for Consideration

1. How can the UNHRC better support the Fact-Finding Mission (FFM) in overcoming persistent telecommunications blackouts and internet shutdowns to collect verified evidence of human rights violations?
2. What specific human rights criteria should the international community establish to trigger the invocation of Article 4(h) of the AU Constitutive Act for a regional humanitarian intervention?
3. Should the current arms embargo, which is legally restricted to the Darfur region, be expanded to a national mandate to prevent the legal import of weapons through Port Sudan that are subsequently diverted to conflict zones?

4. In light of the SAF's rejection of UAE participation in peace talks, how can mediation efforts like the Quad Roadmap be restructured to ensure "Sudanese ownership" while maintaining international pressure?
5. What immediate mechanisms can be implemented to protect humanitarian aid convoys from targeted drone strikes and systematic looting by belligerents?
6. How should the Council address the legal status of individuals indicted by the International Criminal Court (ICC) who escaped custody at the start of the war, and what impact does their continued freedom have on current cycles of impunity?
7. What long-term strategies can be developed for the reintegration of child soldiers and the restoration of education for the 10 million children currently out of school?
8. How can the international community incentivize the belligerents to move beyond "pretence and performance" in diplomatic negotiations toward the actual implementation of civilian protection commitments?

11.3 Timeline of Key Events

- **1956:** Sudan gains independence from the joint administration of the United Kingdom and Egypt.
- **1989 (June 30):** General Omar al-Bashir seizes power in a military coup, initiating a thirty-year authoritarian rule.
- **2003:** The Darfur conflict erupts; the al-Bashir regime deploys Janjaweed militias to suppress rebel groups, leading to allegations of genocide.
- **2005 (January 9):** The Comprehensive Peace Agreement (CPA) is signed, ending the Second Sudanese Civil War.
- **2011 (July 9):** South Sudan officially secedes from Sudan following a national referendum.
- **2013:** The Rapid Support Forces (RSF) are formally established by the state, drawing from the remnants of the Janjaweed.
- **2019 (April):** Omar al-Bashir is ousted in a military coup following months of mass civilian protests; a fragile civilian-military transitional government is formed.
- **2021 (October 25):** General al-Burhan (SAF) and General Hemedti (RSF) collaborate on a second coup to overthrow the civilian government and restore military rule.
- **2023 (April 15):** Heavy fighting erupts in Khartoum between the SAF and RSF, marking the start of the current civil war.

- **2025 (March):** The SAF achieves significant momentum, recapturing central Khartoum and the Gezira state.
 - **2025 (May):** Unprecedented long-range drone strikes target critical civilian infrastructure in Port Sudan.
 - **2025 (July 26):** The RSF-aligned Sudan Founding Alliance ("Tasis") announces the creation of a parallel government headquartered in Nyala, South Darfur.
 - **2025 (September 12):** The Quad coalition issues a roadmap for a three-month humanitarian truce and a nine-month transition to civilian rule.
 - **2025 (October 23):** El Fasher falls to the RSF following a 500-day siege, leaving the entire Darfur region under paramilitary control.
 - **2025 (November 14):** The UNHRC adopts Resolution S-38/1, calling for an urgent inquiry into atrocities committed in and around El Fasher.
 - **2025 (December 13):** Drone attacks strike a UNISFA logistics base in Kadugli, killing six peacekeepers and highlighting the escalating risks to international personnel.
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